



**Axel Nova Ventures**

DISCOVERY, BEFORE WE BUILD

QUESTIONS, NOT ASSUMPTIONS

# The things we should not guess.

Our proposal currently rests on estimates for the size of your centre, how money reaches you, and what you teach. Every one of those estimates changes a number in the quote. This document replaces them with facts.

**75**

questions

**16**

that block the quote

**6**

assumptions at risk

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PREPARED FOR

**Pusat Tuisyen Hz Academy**

To be worked through together, not sent and forgotten

**Companion to Proposal v2**

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## Ninety minutes, in the right room

This is not a form to email. It is the agenda for one working session, and it will be faster and more accurate if the right people are in the room with their actual files open.

### Who should be there

- **The owner**, for anything about money, pricing and the decision
- **Whoever reconciles payments**, because they know what actually happens, not what is supposed to happen
- **Whoever manages the WhatsApp groups and class links**
- **One tutor**, ideally one who is not the most enthusiastic. Sceptics find the problems.

### What to have open

- The fee spreadsheet, the real one, not a tidied copy
- Last month's bank statement, redacted as you like
- The current price list you give parents
- The Zoom account settings page
- A tutor payslip, or however tutors are told what they earned
- One of the class WhatsApp groups

## The most useful hour is the one where we watch, not ask

People describe the process they intend to run. Software has to fit the process they actually run. If we can sit with whoever does month-end and watch one reconciliation happen, start to finish, we will learn more than these 75 questions can tell us. The same goes for watching a class link get sent. **If you only give us one thing, give us that.**

## How the questions are marked

**BLOCKS QUOTE** means we cannot give you a firm number until we have the answer. There are 16 of these. Everything else improves the proposal but does not hold it up.

Each section ends with a note explaining **what changes in the proposal** depending on the answer, so you can see why we are asking rather than filling in a form on trust.

## Six assumptions currently doing a lot of work

These are the places where our proposal is guessing. Each one is load-bearing, and we would rather show you where the weight sits than have it fail quietly later.

| WHAT WE ASSUMED                                       | WHAT IT IS HOLDING UP                                                                                                                                        | IF IT IS WRONG                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>700 students at about RM 240 a month</b>           | The free-rider recovery figures, the subscription price, and the comparison against what you spend today. It is the single most-used number in the document. | At RM 120 average, every recovery figure halves and the whole argument weakens.                                         |
| <b>Turnover near RM 2 million</b>                     | Whether LHDN e-Invoice applies to you now. We told you earlier that you were probably exempt, then reversed it when the student count changed.               | Under RM 1m you are exempt, and a chunk of phase 2 scope disappears.                                                    |
| <b>Zoom licence cost of RM 1,700 to 4,200 a month</b> | Your running costs. We guessed at how many classes run simultaneously, because that, not tutor headcount, sets the bill.                                     | Could realistically be RM 400 or RM 8,000. It is the widest number in the proposal.                                     |
| <b>Parents will authorise a monthly direct debit</b>  | The entire payment design, the reminder ladder, and the suspension mechanism. Today parents scan a QR or transfer when they remember.                        | If they will not, we build a different collection model. See the next section, this is the biggest risk in the project. |
| <b>Students can sign in to Zoom as themselves</b>     | The strongest layer of the anti-sharing design.                                                                                                              | Without it the gate still works, but leans more on detection than prevention.                                           |
| <b>Your existing data exports cleanly</b>             | The migration effort inside phase 2, and therefore its price.                                                                                                | Messy or scattered data can add weeks. We would rather find out now.                                                    |

**Why we are being this open about it.** A proposal that hides its assumptions looks more confident and is worth less. You are being asked to spend real money, and you should be able to see exactly which numbers are solid and which are still estimates waiting on you.

## SECTION A

# How big is Hz, exactly

Pelajar, tutor dan kelas. The numbers that size everything else.

**A1** How many students **paid a fee this month**? Not registered, not enrolled at some point, paid. **BLOCKS QUOTE**

**A2** How many students are registered in total, including those who have gone quiet?

**A3** Roughly how do they split across stages?

Sekolah Rendah

Menengah Rendah

Menengah Atas

**A4** How many **households** is that? Siblings share a parent, and the portal is built per guardian.

**A5** How many tutors were paid last month, and how many of those actually taught? **BLOCKS QUOTE**

**A6** How many are full time, and how many teach a few classes alongside another job?

**A7** How many separate classes run in a normal week?

**A8** **At your busiest hour, how many classes are running at the same moment?** **BLOCKS QUOTE**

**What this changes.** A1 and A5 set the subscription price directly, since it is charged per active student. A8 sets your Zoom licence bill, which is currently the widest estimate in the proposal: one licensed host runs one meeting at a time, so a hundred tutors does not mean a hundred licences, peak concurrency does. A4 changes how many parent accounts we create and how many WhatsApp messages you pay Meta for each month.

## SECTION B

# Fees, and what actually arrives

Yuran. What you charge, what you collect, and the gap between them.

**B1** How is a fee decided: flat monthly, per subject, per class attended, or a package? Please show us the price list you give parents. **BLOCKS QUOTE**

**B2** What does the average student actually pay per month, across everything? **BLOCKS QUOTE**

**B3** Are there sibling discounts, multi-subject discounts, scholarships or staff rates?

**B4** Any other charges: registration, deposit, materials, exam or trial fees?

**B5** Last month, how much was **billed** and how much was **collected**?

**B6** How much is outstanding right now, and how old is the oldest unpaid fee?

**B7** What was turnover for the last financial year? **BLOCKS QUOTE**

**B8** If a student joins mid-month, do you pro-rate or charge the full month?

**B9** What is the policy when a student stops: notice period, refunds, deposit returned?

**B10** Do you issue receipts or invoices today, and do they carry numbers?

**What this changes.** B2 multiplies through every recovery figure in the proposal: at RM 240 a month, two percent of students attending free costs you RM 40,320 a year, and at RM 120 it is half that. B7 decides whether LHDN e-Invoice applies to you now, which is a real deadline rather than a feature. B1, B3 and B8 decide how complicated the billing engine has to be, and complicated billing is expensive to build. B5 and B6 tell us how much of the problem is collection versus leakage, which are different problems with different fixes.

## How money reaches you today

We understand parents scan a QR or make an online transfer, and it is tracked by hand in Excel. We want the unglamorous detail, because that is what we are replacing.

**C1** Walk us through one payment from start to finish. What does the parent see, what do they do, what do they send, and to whom? **BLOCKS QUOTE**

.....

**C2** Which account receives the money, and is it in the business name?

.....

**C3** Who checks that a payment arrived, how often, and in which file?

.....

**C4** **How many hours does reconciliation take each month?** An honest estimate, including the chasing.

.....

**C5** What happens when a parent says they paid and you cannot find it?

.....

**C6** Roughly what share pays by QR, by transfer, and by cash?

QR

Transfer

Cash or other

.....

**C7** Have you used a payment gateway before? If it did not work out, what went wrong?

.....

**C8** **Would your parents accept authorising an automatic monthly debit from their account?** Your instinct is worth more here than any survey. **BLOCKS QUOTE**

**What this changes.** C4 is the number that justifies the whole admin build: if reconciliation is eating twenty hours a month, that is a person's week disappearing into a spreadsheet. C8 decides the entire collection design, and it is important enough that the next page is about nothing else.

## Moving 700 families off "pay when you remember"

Our proposal assumes parents will move to automatic monthly collection. That is not a technical change, it is a behaviour change for seven hundred households at once, and it is the part of this project most likely to go wrong.

### Why it is harder than it sounds

- A QR transfer feels like the parent is in control. A standing authorisation feels like giving someone a key to their account.
- Every parent has to be asked once, individually, and some will simply not respond.
- The first failed debit will generate a phone call, and it will be an angry one if the parent was not warned.
- Some banks are not supported, so a fallback is needed from day one, not later.

### How we would do it

- **New students first.** Make authorisation part of enrolment, so the problem stops growing while you solve it.
- **Then cohort by cohort,** not all at once. One class group, learn, adjust, repeat.
- **Keep the QR option running** throughout. Never force a parent to choose between paying and paying your way.
- **Give a reason to switch.** A small discount, or simply never being chased again, converts better than an instruction.

### The honest fallback

If it turns out your parents will not authorise a debit, the system still works and still solves your problem. Fees are still invoiced automatically, reminders still send themselves, payments are still matched to a student, and access still pauses when a fee is unpaid. What changes is that the parent taps a link and confirms, instead of it happening silently. **The collection improves either way. Only the last step of the automation is at risk.**

We are raising this now rather than in month four because it is the kind of risk that is cheap to plan around and expensive to discover.

## SECTION D

# What you teach, and how it is organised

Subjek, kelas dan modul. This becomes the structure of the whole system.

**D1** The full list of subjects you offer today. Please write them all, even the small ones. **BLOCKS QUOTE**

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**D2** Which levels does each subject run at? For example, is Matematik offered from Tahun 4 through Tingkatan 5, or only at certain levels?

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**D3** How do you name a class today? We would like your real naming convention, not a tidy version.

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**D4** Is teaching organised into **modules**, into **terms**, or continuous month to month? **BLOCKS QUOTE**

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**D5** If there are modules, how many per subject, and does a student have to finish one before the next?

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**D6** How long is a class, and how many sessions a week does a student typically attend?

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**D7** What does your year look like: intake dates, term breaks, exam periods, Ramadan and festive adjustments?

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**D8** Does a student enrol subject by subject, or into a package?

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**D9** Who produces teaching materials, and how do students receive them today?

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**What this changes.** D4 is quietly one of the most important questions in this document. A modular structure and a continuous monthly structure produce different billing, different progress tracking and a different parent portal. Getting it wrong means rebuilding the spine later. D1 and D2 become the actual subject catalogue in the system, and D7 drives the calendar that both billing and scheduling read from.



## How a class actually runs

Zoom, links, and the free-rider problem at its source.

- E1** What Zoom plan are you on today, how many licences, and what does it cost a month? **BLOCKS QUOTE**
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- E2** Does each tutor host from their own account, or is one account shared?
- 
- E3** Are classes recorded? Where do recordings live, and who can watch them?
- 
- E4** **Show us exactly how a student gets today's link.** Who posts it, where, and how far in advance?
- 
- E5** Do all students have their own email address, or do younger ones use a parent's?
- 
- E6** Do tutors have an email address at your domain, or personal ones?
- 
- E7** **Would you accept requiring a student to sign in to Zoom as themselves to join?** It is the strongest lock available, and it adds friction on shared family phones. **BLOCKS QUOTE**
- 
- E8** Have you already caught someone attending without paying? How did you find out, and what did you do?
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**What this changes.** E1 tells us whether the Zoom licence figure in the proposal is new money or money you already spend, and it is currently the widest estimate we have. E5 decides whether the sign-in lock is realistic: if half your students share a parent's email, we design the gate differently. E8 gives us the only real evidence anyone has about how big the leak actually is, which is the number the whole business case rests on.

## SECTION F

# Your team, and the work they repeat

Staf dan proses. What the system is actually replacing.

F1 How many admin staff, and what does each one do on a normal day?

F2 Which spreadsheets exist, who owns each one, and how do you keep them agreeing with each other?

F3 How is tutor pay calculated: per hour, per class, per student, or a mix? **BLOCKS QUOTE**

F4 Do all tutors earn the same rate, or does it vary by experience or subject?

F5 Who counts teaching hours today, and where are they written down?

F6 When and how are tutors paid, and how long does preparing payroll take each month?

F7 Has a tutor ever disputed their pay? What caused it?

F8 How does a new student get set up today, from first enquiry to first class?

**What this changes.** F3 and F4 decide how the payroll engine is built, and with a hundred tutors this is the difference between a simple calculation and a rules engine. F6 gives us the hours saved, which is how you will judge whether the system was worth it. F2 tells us how much data migration is really involved: one clean file is a day's work, eleven files that disagree is a fortnight.

## SECTION G

# Parents, and how you talk to them

Ibu bapa. Who they are, and what they keep asking.

**G1** How many WhatsApp groups are there, and who administers them?

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**G2** What gets announced to parents, and how often?

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**G3** What do parents ask you most often? The question you are tired of answering is usually the first thing the portal should show.

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**G4** Do you send progress reports today? If so, how, and how often?

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**G5** What ages are your students, and do the older ones have their own phones?

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**G6** Roughly what share of your parents would you call comfortable with apps and online forms?

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**G7** How does a parent tell you their child will miss a class, and what happens to that fee?

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**What this changes.** G5 and G6 decide how simple the parent portal has to be, and simplicity is expensive to design well. G3 sets what appears on the first screen. G7 sounds minor and is not: absence and make-up policy is one of the most common causes of billing disputes, and it has to be modelled correctly or the invoices will be wrong.

## Systems, data and access

Sistem sedia ada. What exists today, and what we would migrate.

H1 What is stored in Mudeer today, and can it export to Excel? **BLOCKS QUOTE**

H2 What other tools are in daily use: Google Sheets, Forms, Drive, anything else?

H3 Who owns your domain name, and who can change its settings?

H4 Is there a Meta business account, and who controls the advertising account and the budget?

H5 Is there an existing website, and who built it?

H6 What information do you hold about students beyond name and level? IC numbers, school, addresses, medical notes?

H7 Is there anything else you use every day that we have not asked about?

**What this changes.** H1 sizes the migration, which is a real line inside phase 2: one clean export is a day's work, several files that disagree with each other is a fortnight. H6 matters for PDPA, because the more personal the data the more care the system and the consent wording need, and these are minors. H3 and H4 decide whether phase 1 can start immediately or waits on access we do not have.

## SECTION I

# The business, and the decision

Syarikat, pematuhan dan keputusan.

- I1 Is Hz Academy a Sdn Bhd or an Enterprise, and what is the SSM registration number? Payment providers ask for this before they will onboard you. **BLOCKS QUOTE**
- I2 Is there a business bank account in that entity's name?
- I3 Has your accountant said anything to you about LHDN e-Invoice yet?
- I4 Do you have a privacy notice for parents today, in any form?
- I5 Who inside Hz would own this system day to day once it is live?

## SECTION J

# Making this happen

- J1 Who makes this decision, and who signs?
- J2 Have you set aside a budget for this? A range is fine, and it helps us shape the right route rather than guess.
- J3 Is there a date this needs to be working by? A new intake, a term start, a deadline you are working toward?
- J4 Which of the four problems hurts most right now: the free riders, chasing payment, parents not knowing, or suspending non-payers? **BLOCKS QUOTE**
- J5 What would make this a clear no for you? We would rather hear it now than discover it in month three.

**What this changes.** J4 may reorder the whole build. Our proposal puts the website first, but if the free riders and the chasing are what keep you up at night, we can bring that work forward. J3 decides whether the phasing is realistic at all.

TO CLOSE

## Six things to show us, rather than tell us

If the session runs short, skip questions and show us these instead. Every one of them answers several questions at once, and more honestly.

- **The real fee spreadsheet**, opened live, not a cleaned copy
- **One month-end reconciliation**, done in front of us start to finish
- **A class WhatsApp group**, scrolled back a week
- **A tutor payslip**, or however a tutor is told what they earned
- **Your Zoom settings page**, so we can see what is already possible
- **Last month's bank statement**, redacted, to see the shape of how parents pay

### What happens next

Within a week of this session we will send a revised proposal with the estimates replaced by your actual numbers. Some prices will move. We would rather show you a figure that changed because we learned something than defend one we invented.

If any answer turns out to be materially different from what we assumed, we will say so plainly and explain what it changes, including if it makes the project smaller.

Anything still unanswered after the session, we will list openly in the revised proposal as an open item rather than quietly filling the gap with another estimate.



**Axel Nova Ventures**

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